ARDA ÜNAL

Istanbul, Turkey | +90 532 266 50 50 | ardaunal1000@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/arda-ünal | github.com/King-Middle | https://university-prep-one.vercel.app/index.html

EDUCATION

SEV American College **September 2023 - Present**

- International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP), Turkish National Education Diploma (MEB)
- **HL**: Mathematics: Analysis and Approaches, Physics, Computer Science; **SL**: English A: Language and Literature, Turkish A: Language and Literature, Turkey in the Twentieth Century (TITC)
- **GPA:** Grade 9: 90.77, Grade 10: 91.18, Grade 11: 89.53
- **SAT:** 1410 Math: 800 ERW: 610
- **IELTS:** 7.5; Listening: 8.0, Reading: 7.5, Speaking: 7.0, Writing: 6.5

Python Programming and Mathematics, Aziz Nesin Mathematics Village **August 2025 (2 weeks)**

- Applied Python to mathematical modeling, connecting encryption and validation with computational methods.

AI and Machine Learning Programme, Immerse Education, Oxford **July 2025 (2 weeks)**

- Studied neural networks, machine learning, and deep learning under Prof. Mohammedreza Soltaninejad.

PROJECTS

HamdiAI, LSTM-Based Financial Forecasting System **August 2025 - Present**

- Built a neural network with Python and TensorFlow using 5 years of stock data and 28 macroeconomic indicators.
- Developed the project into a multi-layer LSTM time-series model, optimizing time windows and hyperparameters.
- Designed and deployed the system with free and premium plans; patent application filed (No. 2026/016864).

Flying Up, 3D Indie Game **April - July 2025**

- Developed and published a 3D game on Steam using C# and Unity, applying trigonometry and vector math.
- Designed challenging mechanics and obstacles to encourage persistence; sold 46 copies on Steam.

EXPERIENCE & ACTIVITIES

Pianist **December 2012 - Present**

- Played piano for 14 years; earned ABRSM Grade 8 Merit with a score of 127/150; performed in 5 recitals.

Independent Writer, Medium **October 2025 - Present**

- Published 2 articles on stock prediction, development failures, and ethical issues surrounding AI in finance.

Digital Citizen Ambassador and Writer, SEV School Magazine **September 2025 - Present**

- Researched digital citizenship topics and published 2 articles on internet risks and social comparison.

Research Intern, Özyeğin University Summer Research Program **June 2026 - September 2026**

- Researched social media's influence on high school students' financial literacy under Prof. Sebahattin Demirkan.
- Created a financial literacy survey and analyzed 120+ responses on budgeting, saving, and financial knowledge.

Researcher, Pioneer Academics Research Program **June 2026 - August 2026**

- Researched under Prof. Bencosme; wrote a 20-page paper, "Algorithmic Detection of Financial Fake News."
- Compared two models using the FakeNewsNet; achieved a 96.05% F1 score with the final model.

Community Engagement Lead, SEV American College FRC Robotics Club **July 2025 - August 2025**

- Led an AI workshop for 80 kindergarten students; introduced basic AI concepts through image creation.

Robotics Team Member, Sev American College FRC Robotics Club **September 2023 - June 2024**

- Built and coded an FRC robot, reviewing previous code for updates and contributing to mechanical development.
- Competed in the Bosphorus Regional Finals.

HONORS & AWARDS

University of Rochester, Xerox Award for Innovation and Information Technology **(2026);** Worcester Polytechnic Institute, WPI Innovation Award ($25,000 Scholarship) **(2026);** Purple Comet Math Meet, 1st Globally (958 teams) and 1st in Turkey (112 teams) **(2026);** KİMFİBİ Science Competition, Physics Champion **(2026);** University of Waterloo Mathematics Competitions, School Champion; Fermat Medal and Hypatia Medal **(2026);** ASMA Mathematics Competition, 2nd Place (School Level) **(2025);** University of Waterloo Mathematics Competitions, School Champion; Pascal, Cayley and Fermat Medals **(2025);** Turkey Intelligence Foundation National Exam, 43rd **(2025)** University of Waterloo Mathematics Competitions, School Champion **(2024);** Pascal, Cayley and Fermat Medals **(2024);** Turkey Intelligence Foundation National Exam, 52nd **(2024)**